

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Littlest Guardian

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: guardianship.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

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For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Look after the places that look after you, a little every day, even if the mess isn't yours.

Say it together

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
path	a little track you walk along	walk two fingers across your arm
storm	strong wind and rain	wave your arms like wind
driftwood	wood the sea brings onto the beach	hold your arms out like a log
colony	a big group of animals that live together	wave your arms to show lots of friends
look after	to take care of something	hug your arms around something

A gentle note

Safety first for any tidy-up outdoors: gloves, a grown-up, and never touch anything sharp, glass, needles or fishing line.

Don't blame people for the mess or lecture about pollution. In the story, the mess comes from a storm.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Tama

Little penguin (kororā)

The littlest guardian of the path home



Aroha

Rakiura tokoeka (Stewart Island kiwi)

Tama's strong-legged best friend



The three chicks

Little penguin chicks

The next little guardians

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How did they feel?

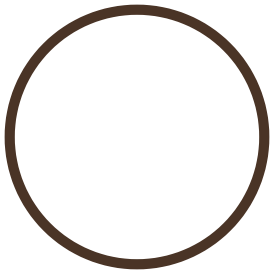
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The penguins waddle home up the sandy path.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

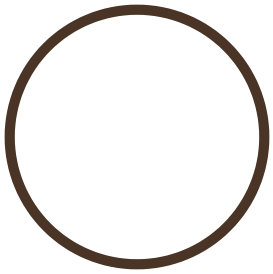


Moment 2

‘Then I’ll start little.’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

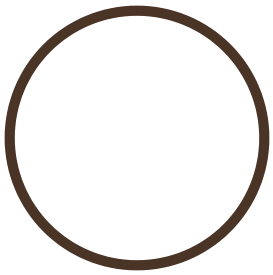


Moment 3

The colony walks home; nobody trips.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

path a little track you walk along

path path

storm strong wind and rain

storm storm

driftwood wood the sea brings onto the beach

driftwood

Tama the hero of the story

Tama Tama

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Tama showed guardianship. Draw a time when you showed guardianship too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Glowing shell edges

You need: White paper, scissors, a dark display board

Cut and decorate white shells. Line the edges of a paper path on the board so ‘everyone can find their way home’.

Start little

Pick up three pieces of litter on your next walk, with a grown-up and gloves. Little things add up!

Penguin waddle

Keep your arms by your sides like flippers and waddle across the room. Can you do it in a line, like a raft of penguins coming home?

Sniff like a kiwi

Hide something smelly, like an orange peel, under a cup. Can you find it with your nose and eyes closed?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Littlest Guardian are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Tama

Little penguin (kororā)

Little penguins use their paddle-like flippers to 'fly' through the water at up to 6 km/h.



Aroha

Rakiura tokoeka (Stewart Island kiwi)

A kiwi egg is about 20% of its mother's weight, and six times bigger than normal for a bird its size. The tokoeka's egg is pale green and about 13 cm long.



The three chicks

Little penguin chicks

In its first year, a young little penguin can travel more than 1,000 km.

Story or real?

Real little penguins really do walk the same path home every night, all in a group. But a penguin with baby fluff on its head would still be a chick waiting at the nest, not out on the beach. And penguins don't tidy paths: people do that job for them.

Where they really live

The book's beach has no name, so we picked one where little penguins live and kiwi really walk on the sand: Stewart Island / Rakiura, at the bottom of New Zealand.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-littlest-guardian

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What kind of bird is this? Have you ever seen a penguin this small? Where do you think it lives?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 1

Why did Tama say ‘It’s not my mess’ at first?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 2

What made him change his mind?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 3

How can someone very small make a big difference?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 4

Why did Tama keep going even when nobody noticed?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 5

What place do you love that you could look after?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 6

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Guardianship hero

This is to say that

_____

showed guardianship, just like Tama.

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

Signed _____ Date _____

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